



Nokia E65

Not quite the E...

As much as common sense tells us to avoid slider phones for obvious reasons—as in moving parts, wear and tear—they're hot! The E65 is red-hot (literally), and it's available in mocha, too. The entirely matte-finished body offers good grip, and it manages to also look classy. Red-russet brown really—might not appeal to all, but the soft contours are nice.

With Bluetooth, Wi-Fi, 3G, EDGE, and more, the E65 is a business-oriented device with some artistic flair. The number keypad is well-laid-out with raised demarcations on each key, similar to the N95—but remember there's no QWERTY. Keypad backlighting is good. The 2MP camera and the music player are pretty ordinary.



Pop the hood and it's a Symbian S60 9.1 device. Quick Office has been provided, but it's Word and Excel editing at its barest (no document creation). GPS software is bundled: it'll work with any Bluetooth GPS

device. There's also a pretty nifty text-to-speech module that will read out data whose menus are placed in the Voice Aid folder. Contacts can be read out, as can phone numbers, recent calls, and the time. You also get a voice assist while dialling, which will help (only if you remember the number) in the event of mis-dialling while in a hurry. Still, we think the software needs a lot of work to be functional.

The phone is slow, though, especially while using the voice functions—which bespeaks low memory. Call quality is good, but not on par with some of the other Nokia phones we've

tested. Calls disconnect easily when reception strength is at one tower.

At Rs 22,469, the E65 isn't the definitive business phone that the E series label indicates it to be. A phone with very similar specifications and functions with a cheaper price tag comes to mind—the N80. But then all new phones are costly, and a couple of price cuts may see this hottie become popular.

Specifications

Weight: 115 gm; dimensions: 105 x 49 x 15.5 mm (L x W x H); screen: 240 x 320 (16M colours); 50 MB shared memory; 2MP camera; GPRS, EDGE, 3G, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, IR, and USB connectivity

Contact: Nokia India
Phone: 30303838
E-mail: ext-manoj.goel@nokia.com
Web site: www.nokia.com
Price: Rs 22,469

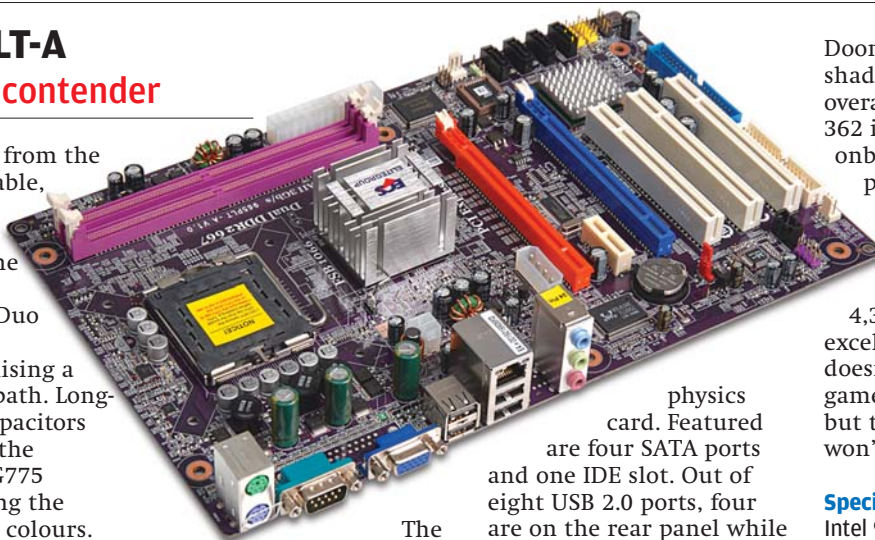
RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆

ECS 965PLT-A

The budget contender

The 965 PLT-A, from the Elitegroup stable, targets the value-conscious. Straight out of the box, the board supports Core 2 Duo and Core 2 Quad processors, promising a decent upgrade path. Long-life solid state capacitors are only used in the vicinity of the LG775 socket, showcasing the board's "budget" colours.

The use of the 946GZ chipset limits FSB support to 1033 MHz, which will get the job done only for now. Though there is dual-channel DDR2 support, addition capacity is restricted to two DIMM slots, meaning a max of 4 GB of RAM. Support for high-speed DDR2 modules is restricted to 667MHz.



The 16x PCIe slot provides the vital graphics expansion capability, along with one 4x PCIe slot for a

physics card. Featured are four SATA ports and one IDE slot. Out of eight USB 2.0 ports, four are on the rear panel while the rest of them are expandable through the on-board jacks using the PCI bracket provided alongside.

The board scored 3598 in PC Mark 05 when we used an Intel Core 2 Duo E6700, meaning it's an average performer. In our game tests, the board churned out 11.7 fps in

Doom 3 at 1024 x 768 with shadows disabled. The overall 3D Mark score of 362 indicates mediocre onboard graphics performance.

The 946GZ chipset does a respectable job for the price (Rs 4,300). The board doesn't excel in any department; it doesn't pack a punch for gamers and overclockers—but the just-average guy won't complain.

Specifications

Intel 946GZ and ICH7 chipset; Socket 775; Core 2 Duo / Quad ready; 1066 / 800 FSB; DDR2 667 / 533 MHz; integrated Intel Graphics Media Accelerator 3000; 4 SATA ports

Contact: Zenith Technologies
Phone: 9323584048
E-mail: malay.ray@zenith-india.com
Web site: www.ecs.com.tw
Price: Rs 4,300

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★☆
Features	★★★★☆
Ease of use	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆